

Microsoft and Google's staggering water consumption rates for AI

Posted by u/Alsupercharged • 0 points • 76 comments

AI, with its vast resource needs, is raising concerns over sustainability and environmental impact. Last year, Microsoft's data centers drained over 2,500 Olympic-sized swimming pools worth of water, reflecting a 34% increase from the previous year. Google also reported a 20% water consumption increase over the same period.

To stay on top of the latest advancements in AI, [look here first.](https://supercharged-ai.beehiiv.com/subscribe?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=ai-water&utm_campaign=campaign)

<https://preview.redd.it/npr6uja0crnb1.png?width=990&format=png&auto=webp&s=b775754b9d42a8129fff2cae675f63c3a291f7bc>

****A deeper look at AI's water footprint****

- * The growth of AI and related technologies increases the need for vast server farms, which depend heavily on water for cooling purposes.
- * The spike in water usage can be attributed primarily to AI, as per Shaolei Ren, a researcher at the UC, Riverside, who focuses on AI's environmental impact.
- * For every 5 to 50 prompts submitted to ChatGPT, it consumes about 500 ml of water, according to an upcoming paper from Professor Ren's team.

****Big Tech and Responsible Water Usage****

- * Recognizing their significant water consumption, tech companies like Google have voiced concerns and are exploring ways to mitigate the negative effects.
- * Google has committed to responsible water usage, which includes assessing where and how their water usage might affect surrounding areas.

[(source)](<https://www.independent.co.uk/tech/ai-water-energy-artificial-intelligence-b2409356.html>)

****P.S.** If you like this kind of analysis, **** I write [a free newsletter](https://supercharged-ai.beehiiv.com/subscribe?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=ai-water&utm_campaign=campaign)** that explores the latest AI developments. Professionals

from Google, Meta, and OpenAI are already reading it.

Comments

u/gantonic • 1 points • 2023-09-16 21:34 UTC

staggering water consumption quantified:

Olympic size pools measure: 50 metres long, 25 metres wide, and a minimum of 2 metres deep. (25m x 50m x 2m = 2,500m³; 1L = 0.001m³ so 2,500 x 1000 = 2,500,000L) ****660,430 gallons**** of water.

660,430 gallons/ pool x 2,500 pools =

1,651,075,000 gallons

There are ****326,000,000,000,000,000,000 gallons**** water on the planet.

​

1,651,075,000 gallons / 326,000,000,000,000,000,000 gallons

****0.00000000000000506% available water on Earth used.****

****Also, heated water turns into water vapor which accumulated and becomes liquid water again sooooo acshually 0% water is really consumed.****

u/lagreatman • 1 points • 2023-09-16 17:28 UTC

People don't understand water consumption. Consumption means lost into the atmosphere. If you live in an apartment, you basically consume no water; your water for bathing, toilet flushing, etc., is not "consumed".

u/Oswald_Hydrabot • 2 points • 2023-09-12 23:23 UTC

The fuck?

Is it not cooled off and cycled back through?

The fuck is this article going on about?

u/5wing4 • 1 points • 2023-09-12 17:50 UTC

Please tell me water is causing even more global warming. I dare you.

u/5wing4 • 1 points • 2023-09-12 17:49 UTC

Water isn't consumed... no matter what you do with it, as long as it isn't contaminated it is the most renewable thing on the planet.